



UCLA Open Source Meetup

Keeping the World on Time, and where this fits in the UC OSPO Network

Leigh Phan · Tim Dennis
UCLA OSPO · UCLA Library

Welcome: why time zones are an open source story

Today: **Prof. Paul Eggert** (UCLA Computer Science) on the **Time Zone Database (tzdb)**.

- A small, volunteer-maintained project that quietly sits under operating systems, programming languages, phones, and the timestamps on our documents and photos
- When a government changes its clocks, someone has to notice, verify, and ship the fix
- Exactly the kind of **invisible infrastructure** an OSPO exists to support

Format: 30–40 min talk, then extended Q&A.
Hybrid and recorded.

UCLA Open Source Meetup

Tuesday, Oct 6, 2026 12:00–1:00 pm

Charles E. Young Research Library,
Room 11630L, and Zoom

Hosted by UCLA OSPO with the UC OSPO Network

[Event page and registration](#)

UCLA is one of six campuses in the UC OSPO Network

A **multi-campus collaboration** treating open source as shared infrastructure.

- **Six campuses:** Santa Cruz, Berkeley, Davis, Los Angeles, Santa Barbara, San Diego
- Launched April 2024, funded by the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation
- Led by UC Santa Cruz

Three thematic areas

- **Discovery:** who is building what across UC
- **Sustainability:** licensing, project health, community
- **Education:** shared training and learning pathways

What UCLA does

UCLA OSPO is based in the UCLA Library and co-leads the network's education work.

Today's meetup is one of the ways campuses bring open source people together locally. Other campuses run theirs too (next slide).

Coming up across the network

Date	Event	Where
Oct 6	UCLA Open Source Meetup: Keeping the World on Time (today)	UCLA, hybrid
Oct 8	How to Contribute to Open Source Software	Eventbrite
Oct 15	UC Berkeley OSPO Monthly Meetup: Open Source AI Models	Berkeley (BIDS), hybrid, 3–5:30 pm
Oct 22	CruzCon: Open Source for Research & Innovation	UC Santa Cruz
Oct 23–24	Reboot the Earth Hackathon	UC Davis
Nov 5	All-Campus Virtual Meetup: Open Source and Tech Transfer	Zoom
Nov 19	UC Berkeley OSPO Monthly Meetup (November)	Berkeley (BIDS), 3–5:30 pm

Full calendar and registration links: ucospo.net/events

Get connected

UCLA OSPO contacts

- **Leigh Phan**, UCLA Library
leighphan@library.ucla.edu
- **Tim Dennis**, UCLA Library
tdennis@library.ucla.edu

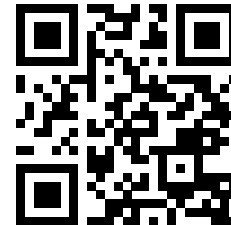
Bring us a project, a licensing question, or a talk idea. We'd like to host more of these.



Scan for these slides

UC OSPO Network: ucospo.net

- Events calendar: ucospo.net/events
- Open coworking and office hours (Zoom):
Tuesdays 10 am, Thursdays 1 pm PT
- UCSB Open Source Lounge: Thursdays
2:30–4:30 pm
- Mailing list and Slack: details on the site



Scan for the UC OSPO Network

Today's speaker: Prof. Paul Eggert



Paul Eggert, UCLA Computer Science

Primary coordinator of the public-domain **Time Zone Database (TZDB)**, which coordinates timestamps on computing devices worldwide. A copy surely resides on your smartphone.

- Designed TZDB's naming standard; manages its data and code amid technical, legal, and political challenges
- Contributor to core free software: GCC, glibc, Coreutils, Diffutils, Gnulib, Emacs
- **2022 Free Software Foundation Award for the Advancement of Free Software**
- Career in industry, then joined UCLA Computer Science, where he is a Teaching Professor

30–40 minute talk, then Q&A.

[IANA Time Zone Database](#) · [tz source on GitHub](#)